

Poems.

* CORA L. BASS. *



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* CORA C. DASS. *



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BY
CORA C. BASS.

[HARLEY VANE.]

LOWELL, MASS.:
LAWLER & CO., PRINTERS, 36 CENTRAL STREET.
1899.

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PREFACE.

Thanks are due to The New York Observer, The Churchman, Zion's Herald, Christian Register, The Standard, Outing, Boston Transcript, Portland Transcript, The New England Home Magazine, and others, for permission to re-print poems of mine that have appeared in their columns.

CORA C. BASS.

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Poems.

THE SWEETEST SONGS.

The sweetest songs are left unsung,
The sweetest themes unread,
The sweetest chords are left unstrung,
The sweetest words unsaid.
How strange it is, and yet how true,
Surpassing mortal ken,
We still can catch a blessed view
Of thought and times and men.

Though brightest paths remain unknown,
And few the heights we tread,
Though we must struggle on alone
With deepest tears unshed;
Although our hearts are anguish wrung
And ev'ry effort pain,
If we can keep another young,
We have not lived in vain.

'Tis said the fairest buds decay;
Perhaps they do, and yet,
Upon the darkest, dullest way
How many flowers are met.
The happy hours so quickly flee
We sigh to see them go,
When out upon life's troubled sea
The moments move so slow.

Shall sweetest songs be left unsung?
The sweetest themes unread?
The sweetest chords be left unstrung?
The sweetest words unsaid?
When we have but to do our best,
The very best we can,
To have the future richly blest
Of God and truth and man.

UNBIDDEN GUESTS.

Good thoughts are like the violet demure—
 So sweet, so pure;
They ope their happy eyes
'Neath stormy skies,
 Calm and secure.

As guests unbidden though perchance they come,
 They make the dumb,
Pale silence blithely ring
And sad lips sing
 Most frolicsome.

SEA AND CLIFF.

The lurid breakers dash in rifts of white
Upon the reef, rebounding to the sky,
And yet by yonder point the trembling surf
In distance dies; as darkness coils around
Our rugged path we pause, each nerve alert.
How grand the march majestic of the night
Amid the raging tempest's grim display
Of rain and hail and that too vivid flash
Which makes the inky blackness more intense!
But now the pall is riven and behold!
The beauteous sun, whose rich, prismatic glow
Illumes a jewelled curtain, poised thereon
A rainbow plumed for flight, while earth lies wrapped
In golden glory. Many a sail full set
Is homeward speeding, bearing happy hearts
To where love anxious waits and eager eyes
Will sweetest welcome give. O, World rejoice!
Confronted by the swift incoming tide,
With hurried step we scale the dizzy cliff,
Delivered by the one all-potent hand,
That ever waits to still life's sternest storms.

THE MARCH OF TIME.

Steadily marching, swift or slow,
Moments and months and days they go.
Moments and months and days and years
Laden with hope and love and tears.

Laden with hope that cheered the way
When earth lay wrapped in twilight gray,
In twilight gray, till shining through
The fair, sweet promise grew and grew.

Fair, sweet promise of joy, of bliss,
We should not, could not, would not, miss
Of bliss so perfect, bliss so true,
We fain would keep that bliss in view.

Steadily marching, swift or slow,
Moments and months and days they go,
Moments and months and days and years,
And then—eternity appears.

A GIFT.

It was given him in youth,
Bestowed by a kingly hand;
Sweet as the flower of truth,
When its first fair buds expand.
It was given him to prize,
To guard with a jealous care;
This gift in a humble guise
But precious beyond compare.

It was given him—he turned
From promise so close concealed,
Although in his soul he yearned
To follow the unrevealed.
He turned from a gift which came
In the flush of boyhood days,
It clung to him just the same
As he trod the world's wild maze.

It was given him—it slept,
But would not be cast aside;
Till into his heart it crept
A-quiver with love and pride.
Yes, into his heart it crept,
He worked with a new-born skill;
And whether he laughed or wept
He worked with a steadfast will.

It was given him—he caught
It close to his heaving breast
And a miracle was wrought,
For a genius stood confessed.
The gift which he held the least
Was the gift the Lord had sent;
Lo, the angel at the feast
He had misnamed, discontent.

WOULD WE DWELL ON THE MOUNTAIN HEIGHT?

Would we dwell on the mountain height
Whence the world is lovely and bright.
Then we must be eager to climb,
Ready and willing to press
For the noble, the true, the sublime,
To comfort, to bless.

Would we stand like heroes of yore
When life's sternest conflicts are o'er,
Would we stand triumphant at last,
Or weep the chances we miss
As the tide of the battle sweeps past—
To conquer is bliss.

Would we see the foemen retreat,
The foemen we dreaded to meet,
Battalions of pain, of despair:—
On! it is never too late!
Let us strive for a heritage fair,
A royal estate.

***CHILL NOT THE HEART THAT TRUSTS
THEE.***

Chill not the heart that trusts thee, O, my soul!
Be brave to bear, to suffer, to forgive;
Life's tempestuous billows wildly roll
But love and live.

Chill not the heart that trusts thee, though thine eyes
With tears are dim, and ev'ry effort pain;
A day reveals, perchance, this sad surprise,
Eternal gain.

Chill not the heart that trusts thee, dark indeed
The way may seem, but sacred is the trust
Of faith, which while it may not stoop to plead
Is ever just.

Chill not the heart that trusts thee, cares defeat
The true, the good, the noble, who can tell?
Truth's eagle glance may yet direct thy feet
And all be well.

Chill not the heart that trusts thee, O, my soul!
Be brave to bear, to suffer—to forgive;
Life's tempestuous billows wildly roll
But love and live.

HE LIES IN STATE.

Frederic T. Greenhalge.

He lies in state
'Neath nature's peerless catafalque of snow,
The friend beloved, the good, the grand, the great,
He lies in state.

In silent state;
Well may the tide of feeling fuller flow,
While men upon his noble worth dilate,
He lies in state.

In silent state,
Our faithful Governor, the fearless foe
Of ev'ry wrong. By memory's pearly gate
He lies in state.

The regal state,
That only kingly souls can come to know,
Which truth and character alone create:
He lies in state.

HOPE-ON-RIVER.

Hope-On-River leads to bliss;
Who would such a journey miss?
O'er the waters, limpid, sweet,
Floating to the Saviour's feet.

Hope-On-River is divine,
Fairer than the storied Rhine;
On its bosom homeward glide,
Moving with the gentle tide.

Hope-On-River runs for all,
Runs beyond the jasper wall—
Runs to weary pilgrims bear
Past the portals of despair.

Hope-On-River ever flows,
Purest, sweetest, mortal knows,
On its waters float to rest
In the city of the blest.

AT SEA.

Afar the timid moonbeams shyly creep
 Behind a purple pall of clouds so drear,
 It smites the captain's loyal heart with fear;
Vainly would he a keener vigil keep,
 Yet few would dream the traitor, Danger, near,
 Till through yon misty curtain clean and clear
 And swift the gleaming lights of death appear,
Twin-born. Alas! men waken from sweet sleep
Too late to seek escape; the vessel thrills
 In ev'ry nerve, an almost human groan
Wells from her tortured breast; she reels, she fills.
 A hundred anguished souls for mercy moan—
But kindly, Time, the storm of terror stills
 And meek Diana treads the night alone.

MIRTH.

Who has not felt his pulses gaily leap
And throb and burn, the feeble step grow light
And freer speed to scale life's fairest height
As some sweet song, or merry jest or deep
Toned humorous note lulls lagging care to sleep.
Man may be mirthful built and yet contrite,
May bear a buoyant heart through darkest night
Whilst hope and love their angel vigil keep
Twin foes of fear and gloom. Oh, loyal soul
That dares to walk upright with dauntless tread;
Amid the din of battle and the roll
Of thunder-guns storm shattered o'er thy head,
Press on, press ever onward, to the goal,
And round thee joy-refulgent freely shed.

FLORA.

In a dainty robe of green
Comes the nodding daffadilly
And the stately Easter lily;
In the meadows cowslips shimmer,
Crocuses with dewdrops glimmer;
April's smile and May's soft splendor
Linger o'er us gentle, tender;
Fair forget-me-nots convene
In the most delightful places;
Mount and vale are wrapped in glory,
Greylock doffs his tippet hoary,
And Wachusett stands new crowned
Thanks to Flora, queen of graces;
Laurel draped and daisy gowned.

WHERE PASSACONAWAY WAS WONT TO STAND.

Where Passaconaway was wont to stand,
Piercing the distance with intrepid eye,
The teeming mills their rhythmic shuttles ply.
Many knelt subservient to the hand
Of that good sachem of a noted band;
But labor like a chieftain, leads us high,
To fairer fields where richer guerdons lie
Than he aspired to win; the bold demand
Of Time is met by a triumphant throng
Which presses onward, upward, evermore;
And cities in their children true as strong
Live worthy the brave men who marched before,
Speeding the hum of Industry's glad song
O'er heights the noble red man trod of yore.

SPRING.

Wooed by thy balmy breath, O witching Spring.
The woodland nymphs are charming us anew,
And yon blue dome acquires a richer hue.
Waked from its winter's sleep on gauzy wing,
The butterfly flits past no more to cling
A slave forlorn to some enamored branch.
How joyfully the laughing lilies launch
Their dainty barques; they safe at anchor swing
In many a sylvan nook. Swift and free
The swallow skims athwart the river's breast
A burnished emblem of the glancing sea
Which ever glimmers in a vague unrest:—
An image beautiful, content to be
By minds diverse in divers colors dressed.

KEARSARGE.

Long as thy sponsors stand in regal pride,
Aurora's kiss on each benignant brow,
Will men with laurel fair thy fame endow;
The stricken Alabama shall provide
The queen gem in thy priceless crown; the tide
Which racked thy battle-scarred and hoary prow,
Yet seeks in rhythm tender to avow
How by Roncador's will, alas, ye died.
Columbia well thy deeds may deify,
In liberty immortal rise, be blest,
While stars with march majestic, tread the sky,
Thy home behold in every free man's breast;
Piratic torch and Boreas but vie
When—lo! with charms sublime they thee invest.

DEAD ON THE FIELD OF BATTLE.

***Written by request, and read at Huntington Hall, Memorial Evening
Services, 1896.***

Dead on the field of battle, the sacrifice complete,
With none to tell the story of that last sublime retreat,
The fearless rush to conquer and the awful price it cost
When riven lines were reeling like a vessel tempest tossed.

Dead on the field of battle, the glowing words inspire
The courage of the hero as he meets the foeman's fire;
His bayonet is flashing in the thickest of the fight,
An invincible avenger of liberty and right.

Dead on the field of battle, away from home and friends
And dying for the country ev'ry loyal son defends,
The clash of arms around him with the battlefield his bier,
He gives his life a ransom for the flag he holds so dear.

Dead on the field of battle, untroubled by its roar
The willing hands are quiet as they never were before;
The eager eyes are fading and the pleasant smile has flown,
But the record he is leaving is evermore his own.

Dead on the field of battle, we search but search in vain
To find the missing martyr 'mid the legions of the slain;
Downtrodden in the conflict there is nothing left to show
The consecrated service of the one who lies below.

* * * * *

Dead on the field of battle, let patient mourners weep,
Nor dream that eulogies alone can bless the watch they keep;
For sacred is the hallowed spot where fairest blossoms bloom,
And where our starry banner waves above the soldiers' tomb.

Dead on the field of battle, in nameless graves they lie,
A host of gallant comrades 'neath a tender southern sky;
And no man knows the number, or beheld them as they fell,
Or hopes to pierce the silence where they now so calmly dwell

Or hopes to pierce the silence where they now so calmly dwell.

Dead on the field of battle,—on Freedom's holy shrine,
But Honor's hand shall point us to their monument divine,
A catafalque of glory that abides above the brave,
This great and growing Union they so freely died to save.

Dead on the field of battle,—the battlefield of life,
Unmindful of its turmoil and the ceaseless din of strife;
Though many still may linger of the brave, the tried, the true,
They all must quickly gather for the final grand review.

Dead on the field of battle? Nay, living heroes come
With martial note, with banners furled, with sadly muffled drum;
We hear the dirges wailing past upon the fragrant breeze,
And know they swell and sob and die, o'er thousands such as these.

Dead on the field of battle, the bugle sweet and clear
Is telling how they fought and bled, these soldiers we revere;—
These noble comrades, honor crowned, now moving on abreast
To love's eternal camping ground and to eternal rest.

LISTEN, COMRADES.

***Written by request and read at Huntington Hall, Memorial Evening
Services, 1897.***

Listen, comrades, deep and tender is the burden of the strain,
Like a restful benediction to the battle weary brain.
Over vale and wood and mountain, it shall echo far and wide,
Praising those who fought and conquered, praising those who fought and
died.

In the beauty of the springtime with what rapture we have heard
Thrilling notes of martial music till the palsied limbs have stirred,
And we felt to still be marching, marching as we used to do,
With the grand old flag before us and the victory in view.

We were brothers, heroes, comrades, as the charging lines advanced
And the brilliant flash of weapons down the surging columns glanced;
How we struck for home and country through a storm of shot and shell,
And as one we fought and conquered, or as one we fought and fell.

How we struck for home and country 'mid the ardor of the fray,
With our comrades falling 'round us and an eager foe at bay:
Oh, our willing hands were steady and our willing hearts were strong,
Though the furloughs were so fleeting and the way so dark and long.

Oh, our willing hands were steady and our hearts were strong to win,
Though the way was rough and rugged and the serried ranks grew thin;
Though the way was rough and rugged and our eyes were dim with pain,
We beheld the spires of Richmond over hillocks of the slain.

We beheld the spires of Richmond, with prophetic light they shone
In the tranquil southern sunshine as proclaiming her our own;
Yet how solemn was the moment when downtrodden at our feet
Lay the patriot, the comrade, with his martyr's work complete.

We beheld the spires of Richmond and Columbia at peace;—
An eternal badge of glory in the stricken slave's release.
Names, alone, may be forgotten in the ceaseless rush of years,
But our deeds are doubly hallowed by a nation's smiles and tears.

Will the future find us ready:—ready as in sixty-one,
When we heard the voice of freedom in the boom of Sumter's gun?
Faith and hope and love sustain us, e'en as when we sought to stand
In the forefront of the conflict, the defenders of our land.

From the Union constellation not a single star was rent,
For the wealth of pride and party in a common cause were blent;
And the graceful folds above us, bullet scarred and blood embossed
Are a peerless proclamation of the sacrifice and cost.

Well we know the sacred standard guarding ev'ry soldier's grave
Must remain what we have made it, the insignia of the brave;
Precious, speaking of the partings that have sanctified the past,
Holy—for the great reunion we are looking to at last.

Can we, dare we, be despondent, should we hear the midnight call?
Would we shun the gracious welcome, with its day of rest for all?
Nay! a clearer light is dawning when each trusting soul shall seem
Like a vessel gently gliding homeward, heavenward, with the stream.

Honor's meed of fragrant blossoms brightly blooming o'er the dead,
Marks the dear, familiar pathway that their feet were wont to tread;
They are waiting, as are many in this world so sweet and fair,
Waiting, waiting, only waiting, but the waiting is a prayer.

MEMORIAL POEM.

Written by request, and read at Memorial Evening Services, 1898.

Sweet is the breath of the springtime, when the sound of the bugle is heard,
Its soul thrilling pæans swift echo the clear ringing notes of a bird;
And bright is the face of the hillside for summer's own coming arrayed,
The voice of the singer must falter, the beautiful flowers must fade.

Precious and far more enduring than the blessings kind nature bestows
Is Liberty, firmly abiding, a peerless memorial of those
Who turned from their calm avocations to cheerfully hurry away;
For a grateful people preserving the freedom we cherish to-day.

We see them; lo! here is a father, a brother, a lover, a friend,
They are marching, and marching, and marching till their kindred forces
blend;
And boldly they strive to press forward, unawed by the battle's dread din,
So ready to struggle and suffer, to struggle and suffer and win.

Steadfast and faithful and fearless, though every advantage they gain
Is a legacy, cruel, of sorrow to the loved ones of the slain.
Hark! to the booming of cannon, to the shrill piercing scream of a shell,
And yonder poor widow is weeping a lad who at Gettysburg fell.

Leaden hail raining around him, at the head of the column he stood,
Determined if needs be to die there as only a patriot could;
And fighting as brave as a lion; ay, brave as a lion at bay,
He shouted "The Union forever!" and sank in the midst of the fray.

Then holy, thrice holy the record, the blood written record of deeds
Which proves, by the fruit of his effort, the work of the martyr succeeds;
And fitting it is that the blossoms should ever be destined to shed
A shower of delicate perfume o'er the hallowed graves of the dead.

Blessed it is to do homage to the men who would willingly give
The promises fair of the future, that we as a nation might live;
And whether they fell in the conflict, or wounded and weary returned,
May theirs be the glorious tribute the true hearted heroes have earned.

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Sweet is the voice of the springtime when the soldiers assemble as one
To eulogize those who have fallen in the wake of service well done;
Many are quietly sleeping 'neath the blush of the warm southern sky,
But the lilies are blooming above them and the old flag floats on high.

They have bivouacked oft in the south-land, the enemy fully in view,
With cities and armies to conquer, herculean duties to do;
With the earth itself for a pillow, their shelter the heaven's blue dome,
But now all too swiftly and surely, the comrades are gathering home.

Into the Guardian Presence neither peril nor passion intrude,
When low at the feet of the Saviour the fountain of life is renewed;
As long as our country shall prosper, as long as our banner shall wave,
Sever the bonds of oppression as they severed the bonds of the slave.

ARISE, MY SOUL!

Arise, my soul! forsake the shadows dreary,
Where dark and dread battalions line the way;
The grandest heights refuse to make us weary
When we can struggle upward day by day.

Arise, my soul! do swift and valiant battle,
Tread down the foe beneath thy steadfast feet;
Fear not the stern assault, the cannon's rattle,
A moment's failure makes the end more sweet.

Arise, my soul! lo! victory is waiting,
Be not afraid to suffer and to dare;
Push boldly on, no jot of strength abating,
The crown is brighter for the cross we bear.

Arise, my soul! forsake the shadows dreary,
Though dark and dread battalions line the way;
The grandest heights can never make us weary
If we but struggle upward day by day.

A HYMN OF PRAISE.

O what gracious gifts are ours, when on every hand
Bursting buds and blushing flowers beautify the land;
Till a host of treasures lie, delicate and sweet,
'Neath the mantle of the sky, crushed by careless feet.

Many a floral gem is hid in a casket green,
But a zephyr lifts the lid and its worth is seen;
Through the meadows broad and fair, violets demure
Scatter incense rich and rare, happy and secure.

As the seasons glide along, earth's a pleasant place,
Just a miracle of song, typical of grace:
Wondrous visions charm the eye while the moments flee,
Each a message from on high sent to you and me.

See the swallows, how they roam in a ceaseless flight,
Ever on the wing for home chanting their delight.
Dare we steep our raptured souls in external bliss
As life's mystery uprolls from fate's dull abyss?

Hark! the magic touch of Spring wakes a tender chord,
O it is a joy to bring tribute to our Lord;
Jesus calls us from despair, offers peace for strife;
Our's the gift of praise and prayer; His, eternal life.

BRIGHT AS THE SUNSHINE AFTER SHOWERS.

When the heart lies crushed 'neath a load of sorrow,
 When life's broad river moves sad and slow;
When hope is lost in a dread to-morrow,
 Where all is worry and weight and woe;
When hands reject the cross they carry,
 When feet would falter and strength would fail,
When better days seem bound to tarry;
 Eyes grow tearful and lips grow pale.

When even the pleasantest hours are dreary,
 And each new effort is like despair;
When we are so worn and weak and weary,
 We fain would yield to the cruel care;
Bright as the sunshine after showers,
 The smile of a friend illumines the way;
Strewing the rugged path with flowers,
 Turning the even-tide to day.

THE BATTLE OF BUNKER HILL.

No bridges stood uniting shore with shore
And houses, bounded by the busy stream
On either hand, were few; men caught a gleam
Of crippled Boston, through whose highways tore
The troops; embarking, on they swiftly bore
'Mid roaring cannon and the awful scream
Of shells; poor puppets of a royal scheme
To King Taxation's iron rule restore.

The honest sod recoiled from their hot tread,
But baffled fury trod with reckless haste
Till hemmed about by their own slaughtered dead
When twice the dizzy charge had been retraced;
They found no weakling foe was that ahead
And shivered at the task which yet they faced.

Above doomed Charlestown bombs were bursting shrill,
And flaming steeples pierced the pitying sky
As eager feet kept marching, marching by
To where the cheer triumphant sent a thrill
Athwart the loyal breast of Bunker Hill.

"Aim low and fire!" Well might the red-coats fly
Before the "echo" of brave Prescott's cry,
A cry that speared them with defeat's cold chill.
Though twice Columbia's pulse victorious stirred,
Ere twilight could her sable shield prepare,
A long derisive "British yell" was heard
To summon forth battalions of despair;
When it was only victory deferred
To even lure the "Lion" from his lair.

With muskets clubbed our fathers held the slope
Which midnight saw them arming for the fray,
And still they strove to keep the foe at bay;
Beside the fence they saw their comrades cope
With those who would fore'er the star of hope
Eclipse behind the cloudy cloud and say:

eclipse behind the slavery cloud and say.—
"Thus Monarchy subdues her rebel prey."
Although the fields were red they would not grope
But dared the "Glasgow," dared the lance, the gun;
And, founders of a nation, boldly sought
On Prospect's brow the rest so nobly won,
While other lands the blessed tidings caught
Of daring deeds by "mere provincials" done,
And marveled at the skill with which they fought.

RISING TIDE.

Foam flecked the fragrant waves rush gayly up
The creamy beach, or sport amid the reefs,
With song's triumphant, on and on they come;
And as the fair horizon bends her bow
To guard the bay, a "liner" dim discerned
Is signaled ere she softly sinks from view
Behind the purple curtain of the deep.

Glance, graceful gull,—
Through rifts of spray, until my raptured soul
Baptized with joy attunes its eager harp
To Ocean's mood ... so redolent with life,
And hope, and destiny.

THE GLORIOUS FOURTH.

On echo's pinions words inspired went ringing through the land,
To bid the colonies as one for Independence stand,
And Adams, Franklin, Livingston, were typical of men
Who watched the march prophetic of the Jeffersonian pen,
Which wrote: "We are and ought to be" and lo! they seemed to see
A wreath of golden glory frame the magic emblem "*free!*"
Oh, deep the joy that stirred the brave as Philadelphia's bell
Gave forth the grateful tidings in a fervent "all is well!"

And sternest voices quivered while the laughter born of tears
Disclosed a richer cadence in the quick, triumphant cheers;
Though gazing down the vale of time, how could they then behold
The beauty of a government of so divine a mould?
While booming cannon shook the shore for many a dreary day,
Columbia stood majestic 'mid the ardor of the fray;
And in the act which swept aside the royalty of birth
Beheld a matchless kingdom, and the emperor was *Worth*.

No more could Monarchy pretend to plant an iron heel
Upon a weary people or the last forlorn appeal;
And when Britannia rashly strove to break the spell defeat,
She only made the footing of the Union more complete.
For, by Mount Vernon's sacred shade, on Erie's broad expanse,
The foe again was banished by the steady cry: "Advance!"
And laurel wreathed must Perry's name indelibly be traced
Upon the roll of honor which can never be effaced.

The "Glorious Fourth" of Sixty-three saw Vicksburg doomed to fall,
As gallant sons of Freedom pressed rebellion to the wall;
And while progression's brilliant light illumines the tender sky
The heroes of the present must the present need supply.
What happiness to meditate on how the nation grew
Till swift electric chargers dare the steeds of steam pursue;
How good it is to feel, to know, the truth of this decree
That "God made all men equal" and beyond denial "*Free.*"

THE LORD WILL PROVIDE.

"The Lord will provide," a blackbird sings,
Folding to rest his raptured wings;
List to the song of the drowsy wind,—
"The Lord will provide for he is kind."

"The Lord will provide," a farmer's stay,
When storms, like foemen, throng the way;
"Though blight bewilder the crops this year,
The Lord will provide, good wife, no fear."

"The Lord will provide," a widow's moan
Longing for joy the past has known;
The weary needle forgets its woe
As "He will provide," she whispers low.

"The Lord will provide," a sore heart sighed,
"I in his boundless love confide."
A step came staggering to the door;
The Lord will provide forever more.

"The Lord will provide," a father said,
My darlings will not want for bread;
He who sees the wounded sparrow fall
Will surely provide for one and all.

"The Lord will provide," sang Baby Nell;
How sweetly the assurance fell
On the spirit worn with grief and pain,
Till the fainting faith revived again.

"The Lord will provide, my mamma, dear,"
And swift she kisses the healing tear
From the grateful mother's pallid cheek;
"The Lord provides for the poor and weak."

"The Lord will provide," an orphan wails,
.

As every spring of living fails;
"The Lord will provide," the martyr cries
And, lo! with a smiling face he dies.

JOY.

I sought for it everywhere
In the circuit of earth and of air;
In the blessing's ambition will bring;
In beautiful, bountiful spring.
I sought for it high and low,
Where thought of a mortal may go;
But never a trace could I find;
I could not, for lo! I was blind.

THE MISSING PATH.

Why should it seem so pleasant, the path we missed to-day?
With flowers fair and fragrant that ran along the way;
The sky all bright above it; the breezes balmy sweet,
Why should it seem so pleasant, the path we fain would meet.

Why should it seem so pleasant, although we could not see
Its living lines of beauty unfolding full and free?
Well we knew each winding would our weary feet invite,
Gliding upward, onward, through the realms of life and light.

Why should it seem so pleasant, the path we missed to-day,
Blooming fresh and fragrant as the flowers of the May?
The sky all bright above it; the breezes balmy sweet,
Why should it seem so pleasant, the path we fain would meet?

LIFE.

Life is like the ocean
Broad and deep;
Billows of emotion
O'er it sweep;
We must battle boldly
With the tide,
Lest it waft us coldly
Far and wide.

Life is bright or dreary
Where we dwell;
Though our feet are weary,
All is well,
Ever bravely pressing
On our way;
Fairer is the blessing
Day by day.

Life is like a jewel
In the rough;
Cut it, be not cruel
Just enough.
Polish, till its glory
Full, divine,
Tells a noble story;
Even thine.

ANOTHER DAY.

Another day, another day,
How swiftly it has sailed away.
It brought us moments,—precious things,
Of fairy frame and willing wings;
But as they flee, we sigh and say,
"Alas, for thee, another day!"

Another day, another day
Is riding boldly on its way;
May we be brave to do and bear,
And in its full fruition share!
For sweet it is when we can say,
"How good to have another day."

THE FUTURE.

The work of the future! How much it may mean
To you and to me.
'Mid the wide-sweeping meadows of truth we may glean
Unchallenged, unseen;
As blithe as a bee.

And then of a sudden, on some golden morn,
The world shall agree
Of the mother, Ambition, a genius is born;
Nay! be not forlorn,
The future is free.

DO NOT SAY THAT THE WORLD IS COLD.

Do not say that the world is cold,
The world is a glorious place,
And friends are the same as of old
For each has a generous face.
It is only ourselves that have changed,
The present eclipses the past,
And we are too early estranged
From the love which endures to the last.

This pride, is it never to blame?
Is the word so easy to speak
Withheld, while we barter for fame
The life we are yearning to seek?
'Mid the desolate tracks of the soul,
Full oft an oasis is hid
By turning aside from the goal,
Or the too sudden droop of a lid.

Alas! as we go on alone,
How little we value the cost
Of sacrifice, save for our own,
In the joy another has lost.
Should we pause to consider the heart,
And fathom the depth of its grief,
No power could keep us apart,
Though the parting were never so brief.

It is ours to bask if we will
Within the bright sunlight of truth:
To sip of the cup which we fill
In the fair, sweet morning of youth.
And our friends, they are ever our own
To comfort, to cherish, sustain;
Though often the care is unknown,
'Tis enough if we banish the pain.

Enough, when we give of our best,
A brother is cheered on his way;
Enough, if the weary may rest
'Mid the fervid heat of the day.
'Tis enough if the burden we bear
But eases the load of a friend;
Enough, if the burden we share,
We are worthy to share to the end.

A SONG TO THE ZEPHYR.

The drowsy waves are lulled to rest,
Are lulled to rest on ocean's breast;
On ocean's breast that gently swells
Like Moore's delightful "Evening Bells."

Those bells that with bewitching chime
Go pealing down the vale of time;
On echo's wing they swiftly spring,
And then athwart the world they ring.

Oh, dainty zephyr sweep the deep
And bid the languid pulses leap;
Oh, sweep the deep with fragrant sighs,
In sweet communion with the skies.

From favored regions far beyond,
We catch a glimmer of thy wand;
Thy magic wand whose happy charm
Shall every foe of love disarm.

So what care we for idle fear,
For idle fear when thou art near;
When thou art near to waft along
The kindred graces—joy and song.

Oh, dainty zephyr, sweep the deep
Where dimpled muses softly sleep;
Asleep in ocean's arms they lie,
Like autumn in the tranquil sky.

Fulfil the soul's supreme desire,
To liquid notes the harp inspire;
To music sweet as wood and lake
When fair Aurora cries "Awake!"

Ay, dainty zephyr, fan the sea
.....

And bid yon schooner dance with glee;
Yon schooner dance with glee, to breast
The billows in their vague unrest.

Come, O spirit of the breeze,
I hear a whisper in the trees;
A whisper in the trees, and now
I feel fair fingers on my brow.

The harp to sweeter pitch is strung,
To sweeter pitch the chords are rung
Till liquid sweetness stirs the air,
As if an angel floated there.

Floated there in bliss divine,
In bliss too holy to define;
In bliss so high I sigh, I faint,
The image of that bliss to paint.

LAUGH AND BE HAPPY.

Laugh and be happy, laugh while you may,
Laugh 'mid the wild, rushing storms of to-day;
Breasting the current when downward it trends,
Grand is the battle if grandly it ends.

Laugh and be happy; laugh, it is best,
Sailing the wide sweeping sea of unrest;
Though the dark billows are running so high,
Courage! my brother, the haven is nigh.

Laugh and be happy, laugh while you may,
Laugh 'mid the wild, rushing storms of to-day;
Faith, like a beacon light, woos us along,
Fill the glad moments with laughter and song.

SPARE THE TREES.

The noble trees that boldly guard the brave
In pride serene; their lofty domes are sweet
To pavement-weary eyes, and town-worn feet
Move with a freer step as o'er the grave
Of Ladd, of Whitney, their cool banners wave.
How passing fair upon the thriving street
The soothing beauty of this calm retreat;
Awake, O city! and thine ancients save.
What grace the tone refined of sylvan shade
Sheds on the busy square; the Hall, embossed
With figures quaint by Sol himself inlaid.
Throw down the pruning axe and count the cost;
Ay, spare the trees; let none the theme evade,
For what is "time," when such as these are lost.

THOUGHTS OF YOU.

I have thought of you many times
On blissful heights; in the vale of woe;
Memory's chorus smoothly chimes
To a rhythmic measure's mellow flow,
The joyful echo of long ago.

I have prayed for you o'er and o'er,
'Mid a fleet of shadows dark and drear
Coasting close by the silent shore;
My grateful spirit is ever near,
Unchecked by peril, unawed by fear.

I have trusted you, faithful, true,
Though the tempest's wrathful fingers rend
Hope's tortured sails and doubts pursue,
What matter whither the storm may trend?
With love my compass and you my friend.

I have wanted you more and more
While threading the world's delusive maze;
Deaf to its ceaseless rush and roar
Through a dreary medley of weary days,
We still could journey in kindred ways.

I have watched for you, watched in vain,
To the smiling future clinging fast;
The even-time of grief, of pain
Must yield to a beautiful dawn at last
When the heavy clouds have drifted past.

TRUE, AH, TRUE, THE ROSES FALL.

Companion to "Leaf by Leaf the Roses Fall."

True, ah, true, the roses fall,
And in drops the springs run dry;
Slowly, surely, past recall,
Summer beauties hasten by.
True, the roses bloom again
And the springs gush forth anew,
Singing sweeter for the pain
That could check but not subdue.

Ay, we know how deepest gloom
Makes the springs of gladness fail;
But when in their richest bloom
Droop the roses, wan and pale;
Search and find the hope that strives,
Poor, downtrodden germ apart;
Nurture kindly till it thrives,
Fairest blossom of the heart.

Dark may be the days and years
Strewn with leaves of roses dead;
Smile we brighter for the tears
When the northern winds have fled.
Singer sweet, the thought is true,—
Roses fade and springs run dry;
But there's nothing old or new
That has life can ever die.

Sweetest hopes must needs be fed
If they'd spring to life anew,
When grief's winter shall have fled,
Giving place to sun and dew;
When earth withers like the rose,
All its treasure leaves closed up,
Then that other blossom blows
Life immortal in its cup.

LAUGH ON.

Laugh on! happy heart,
For the sunshine part
 Is sweetest to play;
 It works in a way,
The acme of art.

With a merry start
Let it onward dart;
 Through the night, the day,
 Laugh on.

In the busy mart,
The worry and smart;
 Of living be gay
 And banish dismay;
Laugh on! happy heart,
 Laugh on.

THE WORKER BEE.

Through the fields of nodding clover
Comes a dainty little rover;
On from bud to blossom hasting,
Not the smallest moment wasting.
Ever gay and uncomplaining,
Nature's honeyed chalice draining;
Merry little worker bee,
Ev'ry day a jubilee.

Past the "red-cap's" fragrant bower
To a modest sister flower,
In whose tender heart reposes
All the sweets of all the roses;
Then with golden trophies laden
Homeward hums this busy *maiden*;
Merry little worker bee,
Ev'ry day a jubilee.

THE COMFORTER.

He seeketh the rich and the poor,
The weary, long suffering, sad;
He giveth them strength to endure,
He maketh them glad.
Out of the midst of their sorrow
He bringeth them peace;
Ruleth to-day as to-morrow,
When sorrow shall cease.

THE CLOUDS CANNOT LAST FOREVER.

The clouds cannot last forever, my friend,
To-day or to-morrow the sun must shine;
The heaviest showers must have an end,
For that is the Will Divine.
Our hearts are heavy when clouds hang low
And tempests of sorrow sweep the land;
But sooner or later they all must go,
And then we shall understand.

THE HEART THAT IS HARD TO WIN.

Is there a heart that is hard to win,
A heart to itself untrue?
Never is heart so wrapped in sin
That the light cannot creep through.
Never are feet so slow to climb
As the feet too softly shod;
Never is life so full, sublime,
As the life that leads to God.

SLEEP, MINSTREL, SLEEP!

Celia Thaxter.

Sleep, minstrel, sleep!
The island home is lonely, dear, to-day,
And moaning billows ceaseless vigil keep.
Sleep, minstrel, sleep!

Sleep, minstrel, sleep!
A hallowed light illuminates the bay,
Where thy sweet spirit loved to hymn the deep.
Sleep, minstrel, sleep!

Sleep, minstrel, sleep!
Though generations rise and pass away,
Thy songs sublime shall still the silence sweep.
Sleep, minstrel, sleep!

Sleep, minstrel, sleep!
Beside thy couch eternal fountains play
And angels hover near thee:—yet, we weep.
Sleep, minstrel, sleep!

THE STORM.

Off fair Nahant the gulls are sweeping low,
And waves beat wild against the rugged wall
By yonder point. Afar, twin schooners crawl
Close reefed; they well may shun the ruddy glow
That climbs the West, but boldly face the foe.
From boat to boat resounds a warning call
As shore and ocean shiver 'neath a pall
Flame lit. When, tempest-tortured, to and fro
We flee before the gale, while lances flash
From passion-freighted clouds; to hope we cling,
Though thought runs riot. Storm battalions clash!
Can sail survive? Ay, scorn the cruel sting!
One effort more, just one more fearless dash—
And white-browed breakers with rejoicings ring.

'MID ETERNAL SNOW.

Alone, amid the wild secluded heights
Where Winter holds his solitary sway,
We wrestle with the fury of the storm,
The savage sleet and passion-laden gale;
A sleeping avalanche beneath our feet
And ice-capped giants menacing the way.
Behold, athwart the ebon brow of night
The "fire-zoned orb" with beauteous light illumines
A distant mountain's irridescent rim;
And morning flits with swift, impetuous step
Adown the snow-clad slopes, benignant, free.
Below us lie the valleys, urns of gloom,
Concealing nature's precious treasure trove.
From thence a hundred peaks
Proclaim the royal conquest of the dawn;
All rosy-robed and golden-crowned they stand,
Their rich prismatic splendors softly limned
Upon the dappled curtain of the sky.

OUR DEAR ONES.

How tender we are of our dear ones, we never can smile at their pain;
We never can laugh when they sorrow, we never can love them in vain.
How careful we are of our dear ones, what sympathy wakes at a glance;
What happiness waits on their presence to ev'ry new blessing enhance.

How patient we are with our dear ones, though hearts may with anguish be
 wrung;

We ever are one with their sadness, no matter how timid or young.
How gentle we are with our dear ones when swiftly the tide rushes by;
How ready to share in each trouble, how ready to echo each sigh.

How loving we are with our dear ones, ambitious to lighten the cross;
More anxious to carry the burden, the greater the pain and the loss.
How pleasant we are with our dear ones, how gladly with them we rejoice;
How eager to follow their footsteps, from duty, and pleasure, and choice.

EVEN-TIDE.

What ruddy splendor floods the molten west!
The quiet hills with matchless brilliance burn
Like richest jewels set in liquid gold,
Fit diadem to crown the brow of day.
Through tranquil fields in living glory lapped
The river moves triumphant to the sea;
Fair from the mellow distance, mist defined,
Stand forth sedate, the town's own peaceful spires.
Look up! thou weary one, be not cast down,
For sweet the message of the even-tide.

PRESS ON.

Press on! Why shouldst thou falter? Forward, soul!
When, tempest-like, the conflict surges past;
Though o'er thee seething waves of trouble roll,
They cannot last.

Press on! nor faint, nor fail, whate'er betide;
May each successive blow be bravely met,
For hope shall cleave the closer to thy side
And save thee yet.

Press on! Why shouldst thou falter? Forward, soul!
What matter though the way is rough and wild?
If thou canst keep thine eye upon the goal,
Be reconciled.

Press on! the fierce assailant boldly faced
Is half subdued, and he who will may climb;
That life upon a good foundation based
Has conquered Time.

Transcriber's Note

Obvious typographical errors have been silently corrected. Variations in hyphenation have been standardized but all other spelling and punctuation remains unchanged.

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